



Managing the road safety risks of last mile deliveries with telematics: Views among drivers and managers in the UK

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ABSTRACT

Background: Parcel delivery drivers work under significant time pressures and admit to violating speed limits to get the job done. Telematics presents a promising avenue for mitigating these risks, yet its road safety impacts in the home delivery sector remains underexplored. This research explored the use of telematics to monitor speeding among home delivery drivers.

Methods: In-depth interviews were conducted with 20 fleet managers who used telematics and 39 delivery drivers, half using telematics. Template analysis was used to codify the data and verbatim quotes were used to illustrate themes.

Results: Managers emphasised the financial benefits derived from telematics, with safety considerations being secondary. Technology difficulties were also highlighted. Drivers who used telematics, still faced pressure to take risks to meet schedules, but believed telematics helped prevent speeding. Non-telematics users viewed telematics with scepticism.

Conclusions: Managers and drivers using telematics considered them a useful tool in managing road safety. Recommendations include making telematics easier to use, sharing data with drivers and using it to praise and reward safe driving. It is argued that work related road safety needs to be monitored nationally via in depth analysis of fatal and serious incidents involving delivery drivers.

1. Introduction

In the UK, there is evidence that people who driver for work contribute to a third fatalities (Christie and Ward, 2019; Grayson and Helman, 2011) and inappropriate speed was identified as a contributory factor in 56% of road deaths in 2023 (Department for Transport, 2024). The parcel delivery sector has grown in line with the surge in online shopping (Vakulenko et al., 2019; Williams, 2009). Parcel delivery drivers work in a business model predicated on quick deliveries to retain customer satisfaction and, if they are paid per parcel, the faster they deliver the more they earn which has been associated speeding, red light violations, fatigue, and distraction (Christie et al., 2024; Christie and Ward, 2019). Speeding is a known risk factor for collisions (Elvik et al., 2019) and speed management is a central pillar of the safe system (Larsson et al., 2010). Logistics providers can use technologies to manage driving behaviours which are known risk factors for collisions such as speeding. Telematics have been used to understand and manage road risk. Telematics systems involve devices installed in vehicles to gather and transmit data about their location, speed, acceleration, braking, engine diagnostics, and other performance parameters. This data is then sent wirelessly to a central system where it can be

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analysed and used for various purposes including sharing feedback with managers and drivers. Whilst many companies use in-vehicle telematics mobile phone Apps can also be used.

Telematics is used to offer surrogate safety indicators that are connected to the causes of collisions or collision risks. Telematics systems have been studied to assess driver risk profiles in real-world settings and evaluate the benefits of telematics feedback on driving behaviour, particularly in Pay-as-You-Drive (PAYD) insurance schemes. Research shows that implementing telematics reduced crash rates by 37%–50% (Husnjak et al., 2015; Ellison et al., 2015; Reimers and Shiller, 2019).

Other studies have focused on telematics' effect on risky driving behaviours like speeding and harsh braking/acceleration, which are both strongly linked to crash risk (Elvik et al., 2019; Merrikhpour et al., 2014; Toledo and Lotan, 2006; Camden et al., 2019; Soleymanian et al., 2019; Kontaxi et al., 2021a). Providing drivers with feedback on unsafe driving behaviours has led to notable reductions in speeding (15%–80%) and harsh braking (10%–52%). Kontaxi et al. (2021b) explored the impact of personalized feedback on 65 drivers in a naturalistic driving study, which revealed reduced harsh braking and acceleration. Similarly, Newnam et al. (2013) found a decline in risky driving and speeding violations after drivers received weekly reports and feedback identifying areas for improvement. However, some studies, such as Meulenens et al. (2023), reported no significant impact of smartphone-based feedback among young drivers, though the treatment group showed some improvement in positive driving scores.

PAYD insurance schemes have shown that when drivers are made aware of their speeding behaviour and offered financial incentives, this can effectively reduce speeding (Ellison et al., 2015). Stevenson et al. (2019) found that combining telematics feedback with financial incentives could lead to statistically significant improvements in driving behaviour, whereas feedback alone was less effective.

Post-trip interventions, as noted by Payyanadan et al. (2017), have been shown to help drivers modify their driving style and recognise their limitations. Tailored feedback has demonstrated potential for self-regulation and reducing crash risk, while Toledo and Lotan (2006) highlighted the importance of ongoing follow-up to sustain these improvements.

While such systems aim to improve driver skills, other studies have indicated that additional support, such as coaching, is needed alongside telematics feedback (Michelaraki et al., 2021). There are also concerns about sample bias in naturalistic studies, as telematics may primarily benefit drivers who are already safer or who self-select into using telematics products (Ziakopoulos et al., 2022).

In the UK, telematics has been recommended for monitoring and managing the safety of work-related drivers (Pyta et al., 2020). Recent research by Christie et al., (2024) conducted an online survey among nearly 800 last mile delivery around half using telematics.

Box 1 Driver topic guide.

1. Please can you describe your role in the company?
2. What would you say are the main road safety risks involved in delivery work?
3. How would you describe the company's commitment to managing safety of delivery work?
4. Who do you think leads on the management of road safety risk in the company?
5. When you joined the company how much does safety management feature as part of their induction?
6. To what extent do you feel the company cares about your safety on the road?
7. Why do you feel the company uses telematics? Prompt:
 - a. Related to reducing costs of damage
 - b. Related to costs of injuries
 - c. Related to violations/PCNs
 - d. Fuel use
 - e. Insurance costs
 - f. Duty of care for its workers and/or the public
 - g. Corporate image
8. Have you experienced any collisions whilst working?
9. Have you received any licence points whilst working?
10. Do you feel that telematics makes a difference to the way you drive for this business?
11. What are the key indicators the business uses from telematics?
 - a. E.g., Speed, harsh braking, fast acceleration
12. What types of data or feedback do you get about your driving performance?
13. Has telematics data about your own driving behaviour been used by managers to review how to improve your driving?
14. What sorts of actions are taken because of telematics data?
 - a. Companywide measures?
 - b. Individual conversations?
 - c. 'Gaming' (e.g., 'best' driver gets a prize)
15. How often does the company review your telematics data with you?
16. Are you set targets to reduce driver behaviours related to speeding, harsh braking, fast acceleration, (others mentioned)?
17. Are telematics data ever used to reward driver behaviour?
18. What do you think would improve the use of telematics to manage occupational road safety in your business?
19. What do you feel are the best ways for managers to encourage safer driving?
20. Is there anything else you would like to say?

They found that telematics users did not report fewer crashes compared to drivers who did not use telematics. Most drivers, regardless of telematics usage, agreed that the time pressure of delivery work contributed to speeding violations and unsafe or hazardous parking practices. Multivariate analysis showed that damage-related collisions were linked to factors such as driving medium to large vans, unsafe parking behaviours, and penalties for violations, particularly speeding. Although delivery drivers often felt pressure to speed and take risks to meet delivery schedules, they still saw telematics as a tool to enhance safety, share information, and manage performance. In contrast, non-telematics users viewed the technology with scepticism. Christie et al., (2024) concluded that telematics alone may not be sufficient to ensure safety in last-mile deliveries and might even increase delivery pressure, emphasising the need for a combining telematics with a proactive safety culture.

Given that the impact of telematics on managing road safety risks in last mile delivery is unclear we aimed to explore what managers and drivers in delivery companies saw as the main risks in delivery work and what role telematics had in managing these.

2. Method and materials

Participants were recruited through a fieldwork agency who used social media platforms and forums to identify participants. The inclusion criteria for managers were that they managed the last mile delivery of parcels and used telematics. The inclusion criteria for drivers were that they were involved in last mile delivery of small goods and that half of drivers were recruited who had telematics and half that did not.

Semi-structured interviews were conducted with managers of home delivery fleets and drivers who deliver small goods (but excluding meal services or groceries), using cars or vans to understand the views on the risks they faced and their perceptions of the impact of telematics on driver safety. Semi-structured interviews were used based on topic guides related to perceptions of telematics and impact of telematics on driver behaviour and safety.

The topic guide or template was developed based on prior work with delivery drivers in the gig economy (Christie and Ward, 2019) but adapted to new themes that arose in the interview process and were piloted among a few delivery drivers to sense check them. The topic guides acted as the ‘framework’ under which quotes from participants were added. The driver topic guide is shown in box 1 and the manager topic guide is shown in box 2. The driver’s topic guide was amended for drivers who did not use telematics to seek their views on prospective use of telematics. If issues emerged from the interviews that were not captured by the topic guide headings these were added as new themes. For example, the themes of trust, stress and micromanagement related to use of telematics were not anticipated.

All interviews were audio recorded and transcribed. Interviews were typically around 20–30 minutes in length. Participants were compensated for their time. Template analysis was used to code the data (King, 2004). This involved organising and interpreting data

Box 2 Managers topic guide.

1. Please can you describe your role in the company?
2. What would you say are the main road safety risks involved in delivery work?
3. How would you describe the company’s commitment to managing safety of delivery work?
4. Where would you say leadership has come from on this?
5. When you recruit drivers how much does safety management feature as part of their induction?
6. Why are telematics used? Prompt:
 - a. related to reducing costs of damage
 - b. related to costs of injuries
 - c. related to violations/Penalty Charge Notices
 - d. Fuel use
 - e. Insurance costs
7. Do you have any evidence that telematics has made a difference to your business?
8. What are the key indicators you use from telematics?
 - a. E.g., Speed, harsh braking, fast acceleration
9. What types of data do drivers get about their driving performance?
10. What kinds of telematics data prompt you to review the behaviour of drivers?
11. What sorts of actions do you take because of telematics data?
 - a. Companywide measures?
 - b. Individual conversations?
12. How often do you review the data?
13. How often do you report the information to company leaders?
14. Do you set targets to reduce driver behaviours related speeding, harsh braking?
15. Do you ever use telematics data to reward driver behaviour?
16. Have you had any issues with capacity to analyse the data?
17. What would improve the use telematics to manage occupational road safety?
18. Is there anything else you would like to say?

using a coding template, which was refined iteratively, adding or modifying codes as new insights emerged. The process included creating a hierarchical structure to capture relationships between broad and specific themes, allowing flexibility for ongoing adaptation. The goal was to achieve a final interpretation that provided a coherent narrative or explanation of the research. Coding reliability was achieved through checking the coding strategy between the research team. NVivo analysis software was used to organise the transcripts and code them in accordance with the template. Verbatim quotes are selected from a range of participants to exemplify themes. Ethical approval of this study was given by UCL Ethics Committee (no.4129/009). The interviews were conducted throughout 2022.

3. Results

3.1. Samples

In total, 20 managers and 39 drivers were interviewed, 18 of which used telematics. The managers included 10 male and 10 female managers of fleets responsible for home delivery of small parcels, excluding meal and groceries. All managers used telematics and are identified by numbers 1–20. Thirty-nine drivers were interviewed. Participants came from several counties across England, 26% identified as Asian or Black and 23% were female. Of all drivers 31% were under 30, 38% between 31 and 40, 15% were aged 41–50 and the remainder were over 60. Most drivers used large or medium sized vans only four used cars. Of the 39 drivers 18 used telematics. Driver transcripts were numbered 1–39.

3.2. Themes

The themes presented below identify the key messages from the analysis of interviews and largely represents where there is consensus across transcripts but also where views diverge. The data is presented for drivers then managers. Verbatim quotes from transcripts are used to illustrate the themes and are selected from a range of participants.

3.2.1. Drivers' views on road safety risks of parcel delivery work

3.2.1.1. Time pressure. Time pressure for deliveries was the most frequently mentioned road safety risk and was an issue for both drivers irrespective of telematics use. Drivers reported that they may drive above the speed limit, take more risks than they would normally, or 'jump' lights:

'Some days you're doing 100 parcels or more. There's quite a lot of pressure to get round and get them delivered. I will drive over the speed limit at times. I will take chances that I wouldn't normally take. I wouldn't put other people on the road at risk or myself, but I will push it a little bit sometimes.' (014 Telematics).

This was particularly true where there were priority deliveries:

'I would say the pressure will only come from premier deliveries. In [Company name] we have something called before 10.30 and before 12.00. Those parcels need to be delivered by those times. The customers have paid extra money to get them at a certain time. I would give 30% for distraction and pressure and locating addresses.' (035 No Telematics).

A central theme across interviews with drivers using telematics was that their road safety would be improved if the pressure of delivery times was eased:

'They should reduce the package levels. How are they expecting me to deliver over 300 parcels, 160 stops in 9 hours with no break. When I have a break, it shows in the tracking thing that I'm behind. I'm trying to eat, or I need to go to the toilet. They say those things are factored in and they're really not. I think the pressure needs to be reduced a lot more.' (031 Telematics).

3.2.2. Drivers' views of the impact of telematics on their driving

3.2.2.1. Telematics prevents risk taking. Although, some drivers using telematics felt that they were safe drivers and telematics did not impact their driving, the majority felt that telematics prevented them from taking risks that they otherwise would. This was typically in relation to speeding:

'... I think I would probably take more risks and would probably push it in terms of speed. The van I used to drive, I did drive it slightly more erratically than I do the one I've got now, simply because I know I've got the big sign down the side that says [company name] and also the telematics on board. They can monitor everything like speed, where I am, what I'm doing. I am fully aware of it.' (014 Telematics).

3.2.2.2. Telematics cause stress. Some drivers using telematics reported not being able to speed when running behind with deliveries and this was a source of stress for them:

'We can't speed because that is all tracked. But sometimes you are in haste rather than speeding and I think sometimes it is ... not taking risks like going through red light ... but in haste you can lose a bit of concentration. I always say I am a good driver, so I'll be alright. But that haste does affect things. It makes you feel anxious, you are against a stop clock you only have 3 minutes to get to an ETA [estimated time of arrival], you could get there if you could put your foot down but you are in a catch 22, you know you are going to miss it - you can see there are red lights- I am not going to get there unless I jump that light.' (007 Telematics).

Drivers not using telematics generally viewed the technology quite negatively and it was not something they wished to use. This was mainly because they felt it was 'watching you' and that it would impact their ability to deliver parcels on time and consequently would be a cause of stress:

'It would make a difference quite a lot - I would slow down considerably ... When you are on the motorway you do need to go quite quick you want to go over 70 I reckon it would add almost an hour onto your dayif I was behind and I knew I could only drive so fast on the motorway as I can only go to 70 mph when I should be going 85mph to catch up a bit of timethat would make me really panic.' (002 No Telematics).

3.2.3. Drivers' views on improving telematics

3.2.3.1. Share data. Drivers using telematics often discussed that telematics would be improved if the data was shared with them in more detail:

'It would be good if they published it to us as drivers the main things, we look at are the performance side of it. I expect the people higher up might look at the other stuff, but we don't see it.' (008 Telematics).

3.2.3.2. Recognise and reward safe driving. Drivers also felt that telematics would be improved if it was used to recognise safe driving rather than highlighting risky behaviour:

'I don't think they shout about it enough ... you are made aware if you make errors, but nobody tells you who is the best driver. They never say, 'well done John you are the best driver of the month because of this.' ... it would be good if they highlighted the positives not just pick you up on the negatives.' (012 Telematics).

In line with this, a few drivers also felt that providing rewards for safe driving based on telematics data would be an improvement:

'I think if on a monthly basis you're making all your targets with deliveries and also the speed and your driving standards are good, they should reward people with bonuses and that kind of thing ... ' (036 Telematics).

3.2.4. Managers' perceptions of the road safety risks of delivery driving

3.2.4.1. Speeding. Managers described the risks drivers faced in their day-to-day work such as parking on busy roads, driving in the dark and navigating other road users but speeding was the most frequently reported road safety risk involved in delivery work (mentioned by over half of fleet managers). One manager mentioned that if the delivery driver was under pressure to make deliveries quickly, they may be tempted to speed and take other risks. Several managers discussed how they attempted to mitigate the risk of speeding using telematics, managing their drivers' workload, and ensuring their drivers understand the potential consequences of speeding. They also understood their role in identifying dangerous drivers who are a risk to themselves and other road users:

'If you have loads of vans going over the speed limit. It can kill someone.' (Participant 14).

3.2.5. Managers' views of road safety as a priority

3.2.5.1. Safety not a top priority. All fleet managers expressed driver safety as being very important and mentioned this when discussing why they used telematics. However, only a few managers claimed that safety was their highest priority:

'Is it the priority? No. It's not the highest priority, but it's certainly in the top four or five maybe. You know, obviously the highest priority is that we deliver.' (Participant 10).

3.2.5.2. Safety is good for business. However, some managers reported that safety was inadvertently their priority due to the positive impact safe driving has on the company's bottom line:

'... because it affects the bottom line at the end of the day. If our drivers are driving safer, then it costs us less in claims and vehicles off the road and parcels not delivered. So, safety is very important to the company because if we can deliver in a safe way, it saves a lot of hassle.' (Participant 16).

This positive impact seems to be a key reason for why managers perceived telematics as a potentially positive asset to the company, as they could monitor driving behaviour and enforce safe driving speeds and reduce costs to the business. Managers reported that

telematics had improved their drivers' safety through holding drivers accountable for unsafe driving behaviours:

'by letting drivers know you've got the tracker on the van; I think it probably makes some drive a little bit better as well to be honest.' (Participant 12).

Managers suggested that the introduction of telematics had positive impacts. Telematics were reported as reducing the cost of insurance, and the number of driver violations. One manager stated these are interlinked, with a reduction in violations and collisions reducing insurance costs:

'Driver violations and insurance costs, yes, because the two go hand in hand, don't they?' (Participant 17).

To support this impact, managers claimed that since introducing telematics to their company they had received fewer speeding fines:

'Obviously, when we're monitoring things on the spreadsheets and stuff like that sort, you can see things that are dropping. ... speeding fines and ... injuries or insurance claims. So yeah, it seems to be working.' (Participant 5).

This suggests that telematics can protect drivers from engaging in risky behaviours such as speeding as they are constantly being monitored and therefore managers perceived this to have a positive impact on safety.

3.2.5.3. A selling point for the business. Managers also reported that promoting their company's use of telematics was a strong selling point that had led to more contracts being won as they were able to share their data with potential clients:

'I think they've done that from the off because they were a start-up and they have to do because that was one of the biggest selling points to getting contracts through with people.' (Participant 1).

3.2.5.4. Trade-off between driving speed and number of deliveries. Of the few managers who mentioned safety being their number one priority, one manager mentioned that this often came at the cost of delivering packages quickly:

'You know from a safety point of view ..., that possibly means they're not going quite as quick as they probably once were.' (Participant 8).

This could indicate that fully prioritizing safety may come at a cost for the company, such as slower delivery times and less parcels delivered. Overall, telematics was used for both safety and financial reasons, and often both are mentioned as intertwined with safety impacting finance. Safety as 'the end in itself' was rarely, if ever, mentioned.

3.2.6. Managers' views on the driver acceptability of telematics

3.2.6.1. Telematics impacts trust. Although the introduction of telematics was reported to have a positive impact on the safety of drivers, it may come with the cost of contributing to a lack of trust between managers and drivers. Nearly half of managers mentioned the theme of 'Big Brother'. This refers to drivers feeling constantly watched over by managers through the telematics systems installed. One manager reported that it's important not to be like this:

'I don't think you want to become a spy in the cab too much because I think you lose the confidence if the drivers think that they're being watched all the time and micromanaged, I don't think that's a good thing, because I think part of the attraction of the job is that they're out there on their own, doing their own thing.' (Participant 10).

One manager said that to stop drivers feeling uneasy about being watched they discussed the purpose of the telematics with drivers:

'There's nothing worse than feeling somebody's, you know, got their eyes on you. We just explain that we're not trying to catch them out. We're just trying to improve.' (Participant 2).

3.2.7. Managers' views of the usability of telematics

3.2.7.1. Technology problems. Problems were highlighted such as servers going down, GPS dropping out and difficulty interpreting data. Fleet managers depended on GPS data to inform them of where the package is and manage customer expectations:

'... when the system drops down ... your trackers can disappear and it's a bit of a panic station, but you contact the customer services [of the telematics provider] to get an explanation.' (Participant 1).

3.2.7.2. Confusing data. Depending on the system they used, several managers said that they found telematics data confusing and felt out of their depth interpreting the data. Issues of data interpretation and training combined to make managers feel frustrated that their knowledge of the system was poor and incomplete. Regarding interpretation specifically, another manager recommended that a single figure, statement or data summary should be provided at the end of every day for every driver and that this should be easy to understand and cover the basic driving behaviours:

‘... if you looked at every driver’s driving performance, and then produced a daily score or even just sentence on their driving or mark out of 10 as it were.’ (Participant 10).

This manager also said that with large fleets of drivers, it is inefficient to go through all the data so a method such as this would help them review their drivers more easily. One manager recommended a more friendly user guide which should be provided on installation.

3.2.8. Summary of themes

Below is a table which summarises the key facilitators and barriers to the effective use of telematics to manage the road safety of delivery drivers identified in interviews with drivers and managers (Table 1).

4. Discussion

This study explored the role of telematics in managing road safety risks, with a specific focus on reducing speed violations among home delivery drivers. All drivers, irrespective of telematics use often felt pressured to complete deliveries within specific timeframes, leading to potential risky behaviours such as speeding – a narrative that has been found in previous research (Christie and Ward, 2019). This may reflect the main priority of companies being parcel delivery and not driver safety. Therefore, because the priority use of telematics was to track and manage deliveries this may not be sufficient to create safer driving and embed a safety culture (Ismail et al., 2013).

Telematics users expressed positive views toward telematics, indicating a general acceptance of the technology. They believed that telematics reduced their speed, positively influenced their driving behaviour, and improved overall safety as found in naturalistic studies among ‘ordinary drivers’ (e.g. Kontaxi et al., 2021b; Newnam et al., 2013). Non-telematics users, on the other hand, expressed concerns about feeling constantly watched and stressed by the potential impact of telematics on their ability to deliver parcels on time.

Fleet managers perceived telematics as a positive asset, contributing to reduced insurance costs and reduced number of driver violations. Telematics was also seen as a strong selling point that enhanced the company’s ability to secure contracts. The financial impact, safety benefits, and positive effects on customer relations were identified as key factors that made telematics a vital part of the business model. Our study highlighted concerns about a potential lack of trust between managers and drivers due to the constant monitoring associated with telematics. The concept of ‘Big Brother’ emerged, suggesting that telematics might create a tense work environment where drivers feel micromanaged. The introduction of telematics into delivery companies therefore needs to be clearly communicated and along with the aims of telematics (Elving, 2006).

Understanding the role of telematics driver monitoring in reducing speeding behaviour is complicated. Whilst the narratives of drivers and their managers agreed that delivery work involved pressure that can lead to speeding violations and collisions—managers accepted the trade-off between delivery speed and these safety risks. Despite this trade-off, our research shows that telematics has a clear role to play in terms making drivers think about their speed and adapt their driving and clear advantages for managing fleets in the delivery sector.

4.1. Recommendations

To support the management of road safety in the delivery sector we propose the following recommendations:

1. Telematics need to be easy to use with reliable interfaces supported by training to build capacity.

Table 1

Summary of themes related to the barriers and facilitators to the effective use of telematics to manage the road safety of delivery drivers.

Barriers to the effective use of telematics	Mentioned by Managers	Mentioned by Drivers
Technological and data issues:	✓	
• Difficulty interpreting data		
• Faulty technology		
• Lack of capacity for data analysis		
Acceptance of a trade-off between safety and speed of delivery	✓	
Safety not always top priority	✓	
Pressure to deliver parcels quickly	✓	✓
Reduces trust	✓	✓
Creates stress	✓	✓
Facilitators to the effective use of telematics		
Safety reduces business costs	✓	
Improves driver accountability	✓	
Telematics is a business asset	✓	
Telematics prevents risk taking	✓	✓
Use telematics to recognise and reward safe driving		✓
Share telematics data with drivers		✓

2. Telematics data could be shared with drivers in more detail and could be used to praise and reward safe driving and to see if this feedback produces positive results as found in previous research with 'ordinary' drivers
3. Telematic metrics could be used as key performance indicators by companies to promote their corporate image.
4. Case control studies could be conducted to explore which intervention approaches based on telematics data have the greatest impact on driving behaviours such as combinations of sharing data with drivers, recognition, and rewards vs. just the presence of telematics.
5. On a governmental level, work-related road safety should be monitored nationally, with detailed analysis of fatal and serious incidents involving delivery drivers.
6. Future research could explore case studies of how telematics has helped last-mile delivery companies build safety cultures and reduce violations, crashes, and injuries thereby creating a proactive safety culture.
7. Understanding how companies balance fast delivery with safe driving under work pressures is crucial. There needs to be advocacy by leading delivery companies that safety is an investment not a cost.
8. A 'safety first' industry charter could be developed whereby the use of telematics is encouraged alongside a proactive safety culture.
9. Studies could also use telematics data to validate behavioural differences highlighted in social surveys such as those found by Christie et al., (2024).

4.2. Strengths and weaknesses

This was a qualitative study based in England (UK) and by nature cannot be generalised to other contexts, however delivery driving is ubiquitous, and these results would be applicable to many countries with high levels of e-commerce. The companies we recruited were relatively small and it is possible that larger companies have different experiences of using telematics. We do not know how many participants refused to be interviewed and whether there is a non-response bias associated with this. Without evaluating change in driving behaviour, it is not possible to determine whether the introduction of telematics resulted in behaviour change. The strength of the research is that it reveals narratives from managers and drivers about the pressure of delivery work and the accepted trade-offs, especially from a business perspective. It also reveals the facilitators and barriers to using telematics and issues that need to be addressed from a user perspective to maximise their acceptability and efficacy for managing safety.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Nicola Christie: Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Project administration, Methodology, Funding acquisition, Formal analysis, Conceptualization. **Sarah O'Toole:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Project administration. **Alice Holcombe:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Methodology, Formal analysis. **Niamh Bull:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Methodology, Formal analysis. **Shaun Helman:** Writing – review & editing, Writing – original draft, Supervision, Conceptualization.

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Declaration of competing interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

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Data availability

The data that has been used is confidential.

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